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MILLIKEN & COMPANY

WHY COLOR SELLS

**-- A NEW GROWTH OPPORTUNITY
IN LAUNDRY DETERGENT**

Milliken[™]

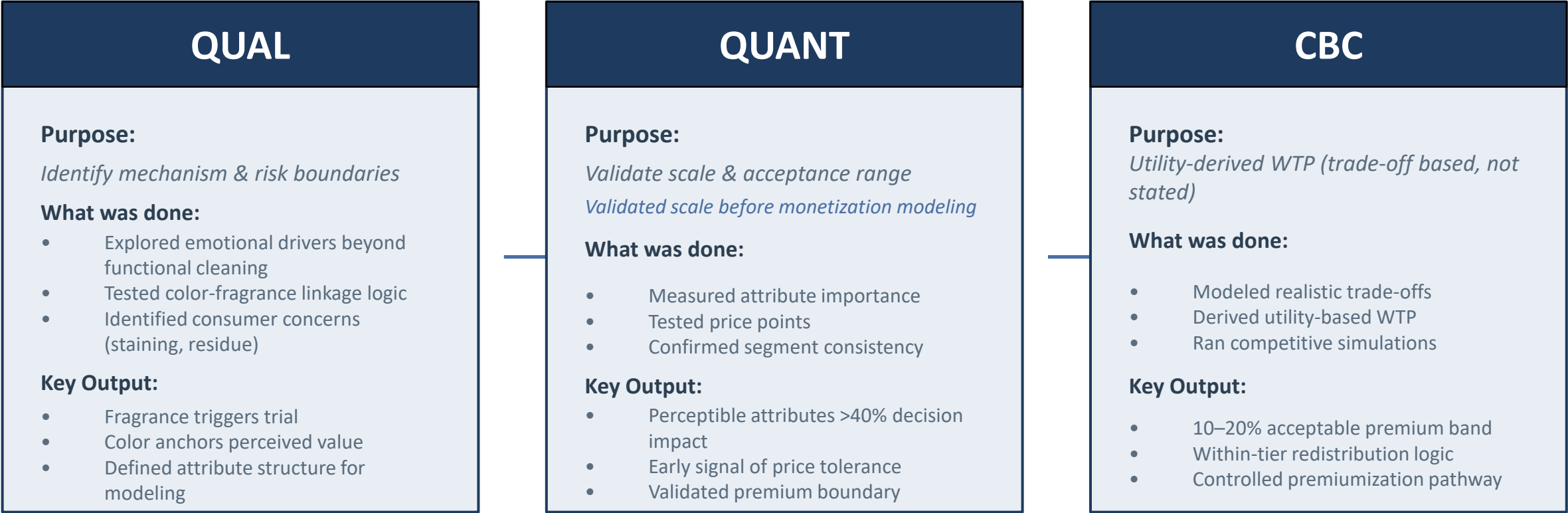
From Function To Emotion Full-color Powders Redefine Detergent For The Next Generation

KEY QUESTIONS

- What **unmet needs and emotional triggers** can color address?
- How much are consumers **willing to pay for “color”** (WTP)?
- What **market share** can be captured, and from which existing products?
- How should brand partners **position and communicate the innovation**?

From Emotional Insight to Monetizable Evidence

Designed backward from commercial decision needs



Emotional value → Utility impact → Pricing elasticity → Commercial decision support

Color Is a Growth Lever for Laundry Detergents

SO WHAT | What This Means for the Business (Decision-ready)

With price remaining the primary threshold, consumer choice has shifted from functional cleaning to emotional reward. This study confirms that color × fragrance × packaging together form a value system that can be perceived, priced, and scaled — delivering both premium and incremental growth, with a clear SKU architecture.



Core Judgement

Fragrance triggers trial (Hook) but is intangible; **color gives fragrance a visual language**, anchoring value throughout the usage cycle.

Hook | Fragrance Trial

Anchor | Color Sustain premium and value



Quantifiable Value of Color

Willingness to Pay (WTP)

Qual + Quant aligned

+10–20%

Clear premium headroom for colored powder; best validated via a flagship SKU before scaling.

Perceived Value Weight (Conjoint)

Trade-pff

>43%

Color × fragrance × packaging account for over 43% of choice; function is the entry ticket.

Optimal Concept (Indicative)

Simulation

26-31%

At key price tiers, the best color–scent–visual combo shows strong competitiveness.



Impact for Customers

What this means for them

This insight answers not “Is color attractive?” but “Does color deserve a place in the brand’s long-term growth strategy — and how to land it with low risk?”

- **Low-risk, repeatable growth path:** Color is the lowest education-cost differentiator, faster and more visible than reformulation.
- **Color–fragrance integration builds a complete value proposition:** Fragrance drives trial; color amplifies experience and value, lifting conversion and repeat.
- **Premium is real but must be structured:** Validate with a flagship SKU first, then use color to tier the portfolio — avoiding blanket price hikes.
- **Clearer portfolio architecture:** Different colors naturally map to different people and occasions, enabling Premium / Gentle / Professional tiers.

Recommended action: Start with one Premium flagship SKU → validate premium & volume → scale the color portfolio.



Impact for Us

What this means for us

The core value of this insight is elevating color from an end-of-formula cost item to a strategic growth lever — moving us from supplier to co-creation partner.

- **Move into product strategy:** Color is validated as a real decision driver, enabling earlier involvement in concept and portfolio planning.
- **Highest-ROI ingredient innovation:** Drive premium and choice without re-engineering the cleaning system — the lowest-risk upgrade path.
- **From one-off supply to system lock-in:** Establish hue and saturation standards via a flagship SKU, then scale across the portfolio to raise switching barriers.
- **From selling color to selling solutions:** Turn technical strengths (high saturation, non-staining, no residue) into reusable value templates.

Our action: Package a default premiumization solution — color–fragrance system + non-staining/no-residue proof + co-creation process.



Key KPIs (Decision & Review)

- **Price validation:** Stable acceptance within the 10–20% premium range.
- **Conversion uplift:** Choice/conversion vs. white baseline at the same price tier.
- **Experience proof:** Scent and “color adds joy” review share.
- **Risk control:** Negative feedback on staining, residue, dissolution, or safety.
- **Translate consumer language into business metrics.**

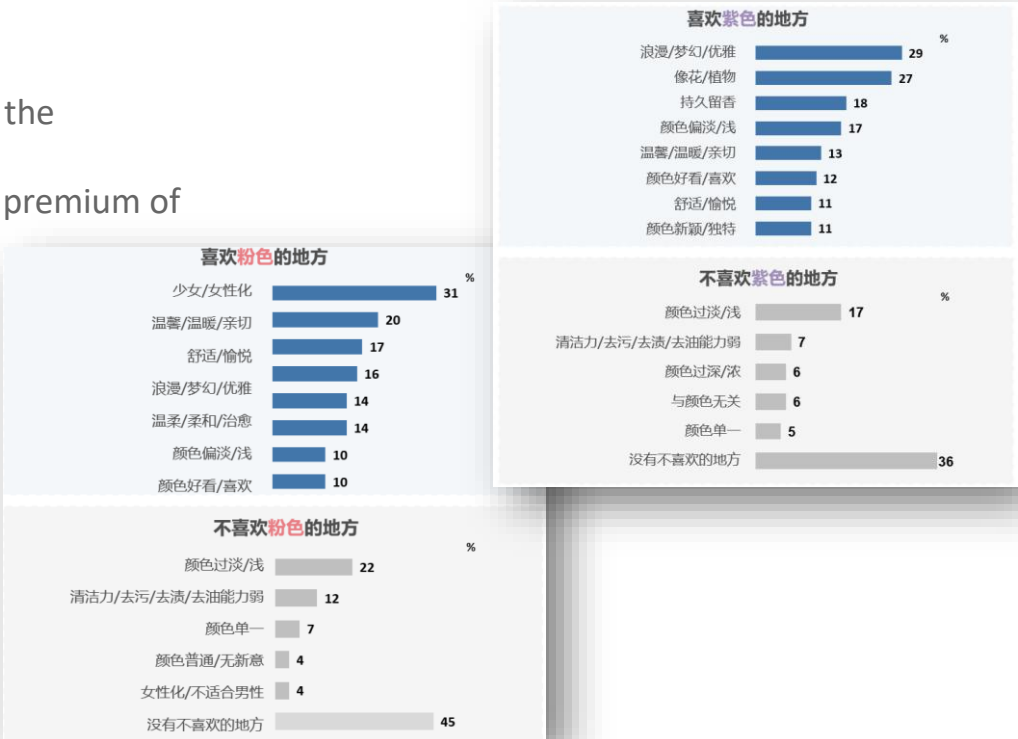
THE CORE CONFLICT — BEYOND "FUNCTIONAL FATIGUE"

- **Consumer Pain Point: The "White Fatigue" Phenomenon**
 - **Data Insight:** Traditional laundry products are suffering from extreme visual stagnation. Quantitative results show that any colored powder generates significantly higher trial interest than standard white.
- **Demand Evolution: From "Function-Driven" to "Self-Pleasing"**
 - **Data Insight:** Younger demographics (ages 18–34) are the primary drivers of this shift. They no longer view laundry as just a cleaning task but as an emotional ritual, - "Self-Pleasing Experiences" (悦己体验).
- **Economic Evidence: The Price Premium for Emotion**
 - **Data Insight:** The qualitative and quantitative synergy confirms that "cleanliness is the entrance ticket, but emotion is the premium ticket."
 - **Willingness to Pay (WTP):** Colored laundry powder commands a measurable price premium of 10% to 20% compared to traditional white powder.

Quali research- "White [powder] that people are tired of looking at" (看腻了的白色).

"Darker shades... signify stronger efficacy and longer-lasting fragrance".

Within the acceptable chromatic range, deeper saturation directly translates to higher functional credibility.



THE SENSORY LOGIC OF COLORED POWDER: STRATEGIC SYMBIOSIS OF COLOR & SCENT

Our research indicates that scent alone has limited premiumization power without a visual counterpart; colored powder completes this sensory loop.

Color: The Anchor of Long-term Value

- **The "Value Anchor":** While fragrance acts as the initial "hook" for the first purchase, color contributes more significantly to sustained value perception throughout the product's life cycle.
- **Breaking Aesthetic Fatigue:** Color signals innovation, premium positioning, and modernization.

The "Chemical Reaction" of Color & Scent

- **Synesthesia & Perception:** When scent and color are highly synchronized (e.g., Pink/Rose, Blue/Ocean, Purple/Woody or Lilac), consumer purchase intent is maximized.
- **Cognitive Efficiency:** This alignment reduces the consumer's "choice cost" and utilizes synesthesia to artificially enhance the perceived intensity and quality of the fragrance.

Sensory Touchpoint Matrix

Element	Strategic Role	Core Contribution	Market Value
Fragrance	The Hook	Triggers initial trial; builds brand memory.	Base Premium
Color	The Value Anchor	Enhances category tier; reinforces functional cues.	10% – 20% Additional Premium
Color + Scent	Experience Loop	Creates "Self-Pleasure" (悦己); drives loyalty.	31% Market Share (Conjoint)

CONJOINT ANALYSIS & STRATEGIC WINNING MODEL

Conjoint analysis reveals the "Trade-off" logic of consumers when evaluating multiple attributes simultaneously. While individual preferences vary, the "Purple-Lilac" configuration emerges as the undisputed market leader in the competitive landscape.

Attribute Importance Ranking (The Decision Drivers)

Data shows that **Price** remains the dominant factor, but Color-Fragrance and Packaging together contribute over 43% of the total decision weight.

- **Price (45%)**: The primary gatekeeper for purchase.
- **Color-Fragrance (25.5%)**: The core differentiator for emotional value
- **Packaging (17.8%)**: A critical visual touchpoint for brand perception.
- **Functionality (11.7%)**: Basic performance expectations.

Importance	Total
Price	45.0%
Color & Fragrance	25.5%
Package	17.8%
Function	11.7%

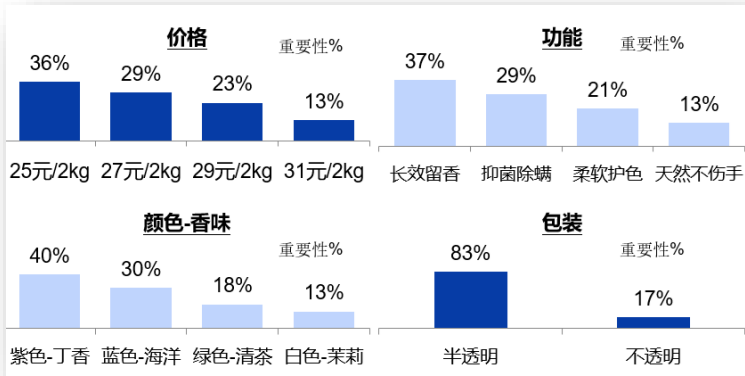
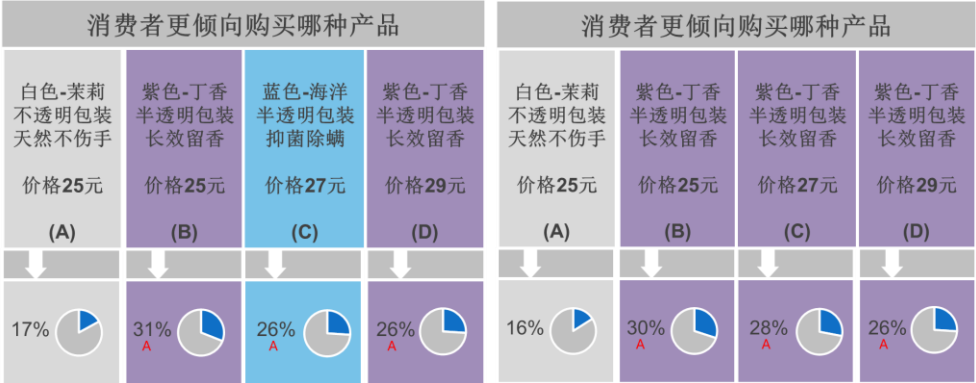
Optimal "Golden Combination" Model

By selecting the top-performing levels from each attribute, we identified the winning concept:

- **Color-Fragrance: Purple-Lilac (40% Preference)** — Outperforming Blue-Ocean (30%), Green-Tea (18%), and White-Jasmine (13%).
- **Packaging: Translucent (83% Preference)** — Significantly preferred over opaque options (17%).
- **Function: Long-lasting Fragrance (37% Preference)** — The highest-rated functional benefit.
- **Price Point: CNY 25/2kg (36% Preference)** — The "Sweet Spot" for maximum conversion.

Strategic Market Simulation

- **Winning Portfolio Expected Market Share: 31%.**
- **Conclusion:** The Purple-Lilac + Translucent Packaging model creates a powerful sensory loop, offering a 10%-20% premium potential over commodity white powders.

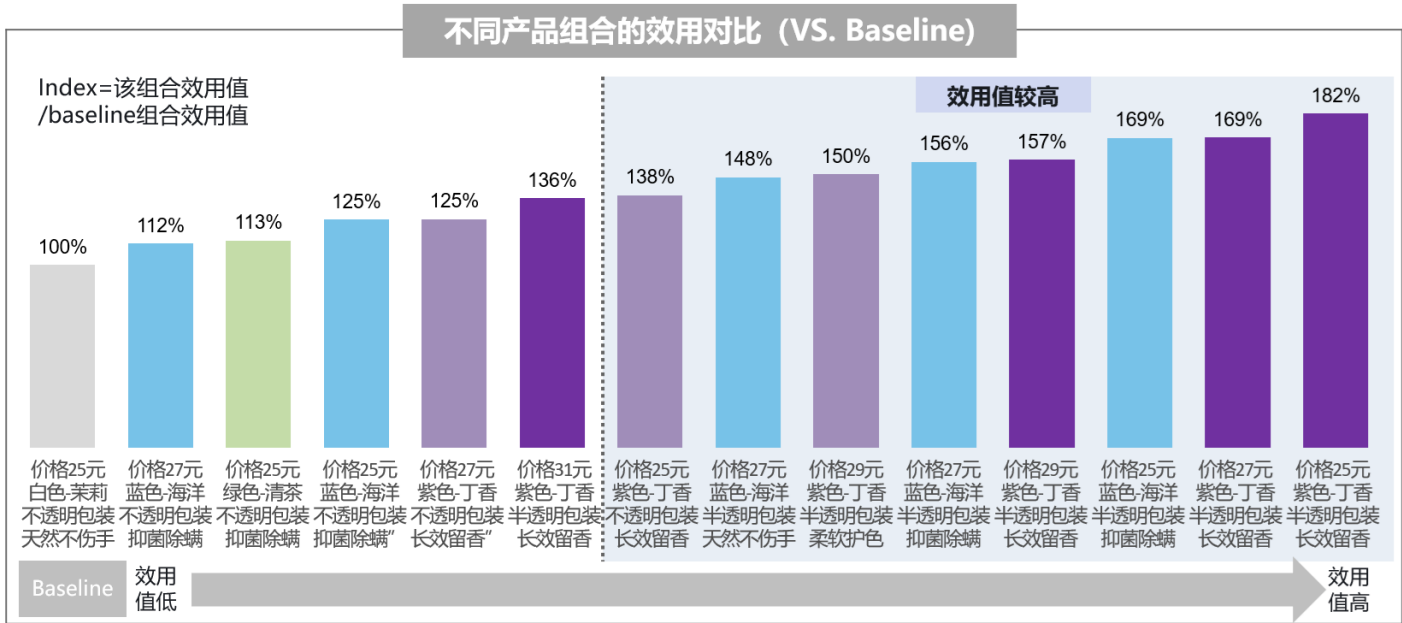


OPTIMIZING PRODUCT MIX FOR MARKET PREMIUMIZATION

Premium aesthetics and functional fragrance synergy are the key catalysts for maximizing consumer value and price elasticity.

- Visual Premium Effect:** All top 6 utility-performing concepts feature "Translucent Packaging." This visual transparency significantly elevates perceived premiumness and consumer trust.
- Scent & Color Synergy:** The "Purple-Lilac" + "Long-lasting Fragrance" combination demonstrates exceptional consumer stickiness, maintaining high utility even at 27 or 29 RMB price points.
- Price Sensitivity Balance:** While 25 RMB yields the highest utility, the 27 RMB concept retains a strong index of 169%.
- Functional Hierarchy:** "Long-lasting Fragrance" outperformed "Anti-bacterial" and "Gentle on Hands" in driving utility.

在以下具有代表性的模拟产品组合中，“25 元+紫色 - 丁香 + 半透明包装 + 长效留香” 的组合具有最高的效用值，效用值达到白色基础组合的1.8倍，是消费者最倾向购买的组合。



Note: Pink color is not in conjoint as its winning concept in market.
Blue & blue translucent packaging are in the test for style differences only.